

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

SILK ROAD

LECTURE-4

ENGLISH

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Topics To Covered

- 1 ... Lec 04. Silk Road.
Summary and Textual questions.
- 2 ...
- 3 ...
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SILK ROAD



The author of the chapter “Silk Road”, Nick Middleton, tells the story of his journey to Mount Kailash in Tibet. He wanted to do the holy walk called the kora, which means going around the sacred mountain. This journey was not just a travel experience for him but also a way to find peace and positivity. He believed that doing the kora would help him think more positively and bring that positive attitude into his everyday life.

SILK ROAD



When the author left a place called Ravu, he was joined by a man named Daniel, and their driver was Tsetan. A kind local woman named Lhamo gave the author a sheepskin coat as a gift to protect him from the cold. This coat was the usual dress of the drokbas, the nomadic herders of Tibet. Tsetan, who was an experienced driver, knew a ^{road} route to Mount Kailash that went southwest and passed through several high mountain passes on the way.

→ Route → Silk Road.

As the author travelled further, he saw wide, dry grasslands where gazelles were eating the short grass. He also noticed dust clouds raised by kyang, the wild donkeys of Tibet. There were lonely drokbas (nomadic herders) taking care of their animals and tents of other nomads guarded by fierce Tibetan ^{dogs} mastiffs. These huge and powerful dogs made the author understand why they were once used as hunting dogs in China's royal courts.

Soon, the group reached snow-covered mountains, which were very difficult to cross. The author noted that the altitude there was 5,210 metres above sea level. Because of the thin air and cold, his body functions slowed down, and he began to suffer from a severe headache.

They finally reached the top of the mountain pass, which was 5,515 metres above sea level and was marked by a pile of rocks. As they started going downhill, the author began to feel better and they stopped at a work camp near a dry salt lake. By the afternoon, they arrived at a small town called Hor. The author found Hor to be a sad and dull place with no greenery, only rocks and dust everywhere. Here, Daniel left the group and went back to Lhasa. The author felt disappointed because he had expected the Mansarovar Lake, on whose shore Hor was located, to be beautiful and peaceful, but instead, he found it dirty and full of garbage.

At last, they reached a guest house in Darchen late at night. The author was unable to sleep because he was not feeling well, so the next morning Tsetan took him to the Darchen medical college. After checking him, the doctors said that the author was fit and could do the kora. Once he was sure that the author was fine, Tsetan went back to Lhasa.

After getting a good night's rest, the author felt much better. Now, Darchen did not seem as bad as before. He described it as a dusty, broken-down town with only a few simple shops. The author noticed that there were very few pilgrims around and thought that he had come too early in the pilgrimage season. Because of the snow blocking the route, he decided not to do the kora alone.

While the author was waiting for the right time and weather to start the kora, he met a man named Norbu. Norbu was an academic researcher from the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences in Beijing, and he was studying the importance of the kora in Buddhist literature. As the author spent more time with him, he got to know Norbu better and learned that Norbu also wanted to do the kora. Since both of them were academicians and shared the same goal, they decided to do the pilgrimage together. The author felt happy and encouraged, thinking that his positive-thinking attitude was bringing good results once again.

Conclusion

Throughout his journey, the author faced many difficulties and hardships, which at times made him feel negative and discouraged. However, he did not give up and continued with determination and hope. In the end, he met Norbu, someone who shared the same interest and purpose of completing the kora. Their shared motivation brought them together, and this lifted the author's spirits. The chapter ends on a positive and hopeful note, showing that positive thinking and perseverance can help overcome challenges and bring good results in life.

Themes of the Chapter

1. **Adventure and Exploration:** The author's journey through the harsh Tibetan landscape.
2. **Faith and Spirituality:** Mount Kailash as a sacred place of worship.
3. **Human Connection:** Kindness and helpfulness of Tibetan people.
4. **Man vs Nature:** Facing challenges of weather, altitude, and terrain.
5. **Cultural Discovery:** Learning about Tibetan customs, traditions, and beliefs.

QUESTION



The article has been titled 'Silk Road.'

ANSWER:

The article is titled Silk Road because the author travelled through the mountains where the ancient Silk Road used to pass, connecting Tibet to China.

QUESTION



Tibetan mastiffs were popular in China's imperial courts.

ANSWER:

Tibetan mastiffs were ferocious and watchful guard dogs. When the author's vehicle entered the property, they chased it down without fear. As a result, they were presented to the Chinese imperial court as a form of tribute from Tibet.

QUESTION



The author's experience at Hor was in stark contrast to earlier accounts of the place.

ANSWER:

The author's experience at Hor contrasted with travel accounts such as those of Kawaguchi and Hedin, who were overcome by the beauty and serenity of the lake, and cried. The author observed a neglected Hor with sparse vegetation, a rocky and dusty landscape, and discarded waste in the surrounding area.

QUESTION



The author thought that his positive thinking strategy worked well after all.

ANSWER:

When the author discovered no pilgrims in Darchen, he began to doubt his positive thinking. But, by chance, he ran into Norbu, who had also come to do kora. He was a professor in Beijing. When he suggested that they both form a team, the author realised that his positive thinking had paid off after all.

QUESTION



The purpose of the author's journey to Mount Kailash.

ANSWER:

The author's trip to Mount Kailash was part of a self-improvement programme. The author wanted to boost his positive thinking, so he went on a pilgrimage called the kora.

QUESTION



The author's physical condition in Darchen.

ANSWER:

At Darchen, one of the author's nostrils became blocked. When he tried to sleep, he got up because his chest felt uneasy, though it was fine once he sat up. When he discovered he couldn't lie down, he tried sleeping by leaning against a wall, but he became afraid of falling asleep due to his breathing problem. He felt better after taking the medication.

QUESTION



The author's meeting with Norbu.

ANSWER:

Norbu and the author met by chance in Darchen's cafe. When Norbu noticed the author reading an English novel, he struck up a conversation, and they soon realised they were both headed for ~~Korla~~^{Korla}. They decided to form a group.

QUESTION



Tsetan's support to the author during the journey.

ANSWER:

Tsetan drove the author from Ravu to Darchen in his four-wheel drive vehicle. He manoeuvred his way through the snowy terrain. When the author became ill, he also took him to the Darchen medical college. Throughout, Tsetan was a dependable and approachable companion.

QUESTION



"As a Buddhist, he told me, he knew that it didn't really matter if I passed away, but he thought it would be bad for business."

ANSWER:

Tsetan was a devout Buddhist who believed that death was not the end of the world. Kailash is a holy place; going there would be better for him because it would transport him to heaven. Then, if the author died there, it would be bad for his business because his credibility in looking after the tourists would be jeopardised, and he might not get any customers later.

Thank
You